Case Study: Phishing Attack

CSACL — Computer Science & Cyber Awareness | Grade 10

Presented by: [Student Name] | Class: Grade 10 | Subject: CSACL

CYBER AWARENESS

SCHOOL PROJECT



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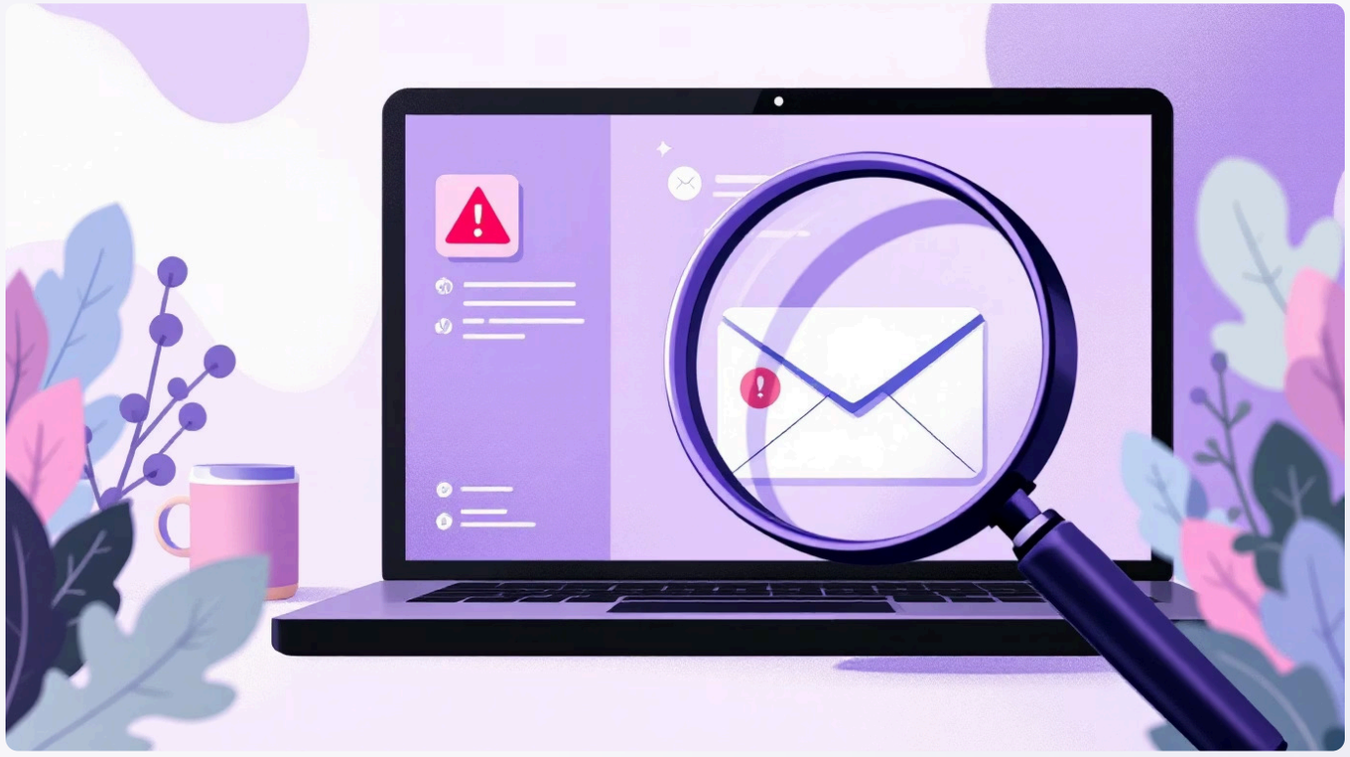


Introduction to Phishing Attack

- Phishing is one of the **most common cybercrimes** in the world today
- Hackers pretend to be trusted people or companies to **steal your information**
- Attacks happen through **emails, SMS, fake websites**, and phone calls
- Goal: steal passwords, bank details, or personal data — *તમારી માહિતી ચોરી!*
- Anyone can be a target — students, teachers, even big companies
- Over **3.4 billion phishing emails** are sent every single day worldwide
- Phishing causes billions of dollars in losses each year globally
- Understanding phishing helps you stay **safe online** — knowledge is your shield!

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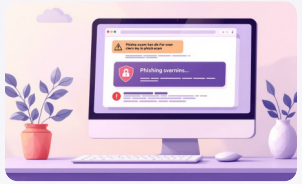
What is Phishing? (Definition)



- **Phishing** = Sending fake messages to trick people into giving away personal info
- The word comes from **"fishing"** — hackers use bait (fake links) to "catch" victims
- Attackers pretend to be banks, Google, Amazon, or your school
- Victims click a link → enter password → hacker steals it immediately
- It is a type of **Social Engineering** attack — manipulating human trust
- Phishing does NOT need technical hacking skills — just clever fake messages
- Even smart people can get fooled if they are not careful
- Phishing is **illegal** under the IT Act in India — punishable by law

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Types of Phishing Attacks

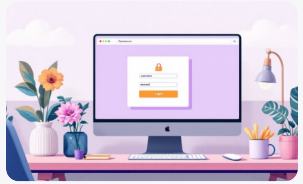


📧 Email Phishing

- Fake emails that look like they're from real companies
- Contains malicious links or attachments
- Most common type — easy to send in bulk

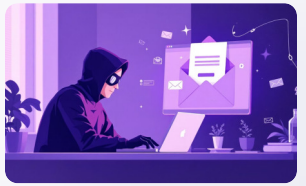
💬 Smishing (SMS)

- Fake text messages on your mobile phone
- "Your account is blocked — click here!"
- Very common in India via WhatsApp & SMS



🌐 Vishing & Website

- Fake websites that copy real login pages
- Vishing = Voice phishing (fake phone calls)
- URL looks similar but has small spelling errors

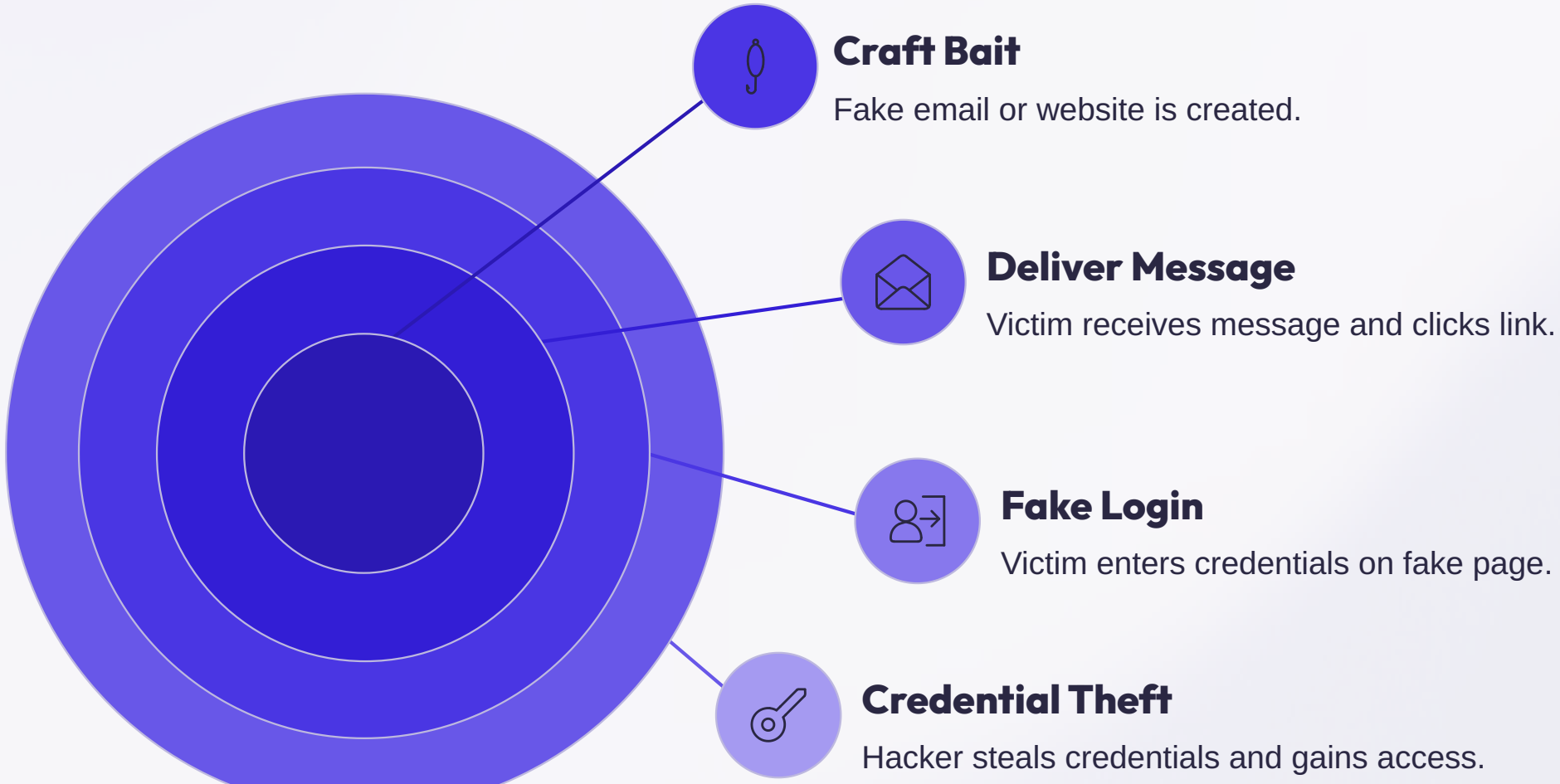


🎯 Spear & Whale Phishing

- Spear = Targeted attack on specific person
- Whale = Attack on CEOs or high-profile people
- More dangerous — uses personal info to seem real

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How a Phishing Attack Works — Step by Step



Craft Bait

Fake email or website is created.

Deliver Message

Victim receives message and clicks link.

Fake Login

Victim enters credentials on fake page.

Credential Theft

Hacker steals credentials and gains access.

The attacker's goal is to make every step look completely legitimate. The victim often doesn't realize what happened until it's too late. **Always think before you click!**

- **Step 1:** Hacker designs a fake email or website that looks real
- **Step 2:** Victim receives the message and feels urgency or fear
- **Step 3:** Victim clicks the link and enters login details on the fake page
- **Step 4:** Hacker captures the credentials and accesses the real account
- The whole attack can happen in **under 60 seconds**
- Hackers often wait days before using stolen accounts to avoid detection

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Real-Life Case Study Example

- **Incident:** A student received an email claiming to be from "Google Security"
- Email said: *"Your account will be deleted in 24 hours — verify now!"*
- Student clicked the link and entered Gmail password on a fake page
- Hacker gained access, changed the password, and locked the student out
- Hacker also accessed linked apps — Instagram, YouTube, and school email
- Similar real case: **2020 Twitter Breach** — hackers phished employees and hacked celebrity accounts
- Another example: Fake "SBI Bank" SMS asking to update KYC — many Indians lost money
- Lesson: **Always check the sender's email address** before trusting any message — *ચેક કરો પહેલાં ક્લિક!*

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Signs of Phishing — How to Identify 🚨



- 🚨 **Urgency:** "Act now or your account will be deleted!"
- 📧 **Sender Check:** Email is from **support@g00gle.com** (zero instead of 'o')
- 🔗 **Link Check:** Hover over link — does URL match the real website?
- 🔑 **Asking for Passwords:** No real company asks for your password via email
- ✏️ **Grammar Mistakes:** Poor spelling = likely a scam
- 📎 **Unexpected Attachments:** Never open unknown .exe or .zip files
- 💬 **Too Good to Be True:** "You won a prize!" — probably a trap
- 🔍 **Trust Your Gut:** If something feels wrong, it probably is!

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Effects of a Phishing Attack

💰 Financial Loss

- Money stolen from bank accounts
- Unauthorized online purchases
- Credit card fraud
- Recovery can take months

🔐 Data Breach

- Passwords and personal info exposed
- Private photos or files leaked
- School or company data compromised
- Identity theft risk increases

😟 Emotional Impact

- Stress, fear, and loss of trust
- Embarrassment among friends
- Anxiety about online safety
- Loss of important memories

⚖️ Legal Trouble

- Hacked account used for crimes
- You may be wrongly blamed
- Reputation damage
- Difficult legal recovery process

- Phishing can destroy **trust, money, and reputation** in minutes
- Recovering a hacked account is **time-consuming and stressful**
- Some effects — like leaked photos — can be **permanent**
- Prevention is always easier than recovery — *બચવું સારું છે!*

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Prevention Methods & Safety Tips 🛡️



- ✅ **Verify the sender** — Check the full email address before trusting
- ✅ **Never click suspicious links** — Type the website URL manually
- ✅ **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)** on all important accounts
- ✅ **Use strong, unique passwords** — Don't reuse passwords
- ✅ **Don't share OTP or passwords** — No real company will ever ask
- ✅ **Update your software** regularly — Updates fix security holes
- ✅ **Report phishing** — Tell a teacher, parent, or cyber cell immediately
- ✅ **Use antivirus software** — It can detect and block many threats

Remember: **Think before you click!** — *પહેલા વિચારો, પછી ક્લિક કરો!*

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Role of Users in Cyber Security

Be Aware

- Stay updated on new phishing tricks
- Share knowledge with friends and family
- Attend cyber awareness workshops

Report & Act

- Report suspicious emails to your teacher or IT admin
- Use India's cyber crime portal: **cybercrime.gov.in**
- Warn others if you spot a scam

Protect Yourself

- Use strong passwords and enable 2FA
- Keep your devices and apps updated
- Log out of shared computers always

Build a Safe Community

- Teach younger students about online safety
- Create a culture of reporting, not hiding
- Be a cyber safety role model



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